



*Incubator Evaluation and Recommendations
Student Ambassador Program University Growth
Spring 2026*

Meet The Team



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Part I (January-February): Incubator Assessment

- Interview existing incubators in other areas to determine successful strategies
- Research what success looks like for incubators, including structures and implementation timelines
- Evaluate the existing early-stage Nashville nonprofit scene and identify potential client opportunities & partnerships
- Provide actionable, step-by-step recommendations for how to build and scale the program

2

Part II (March-April): Student Ambassador Program Expansion

- Expand and tailor the existing program to university level
- Tailor program branding and materials to university students
- Engage with local Nashville universities to identify points of contact and distribute information about the program

Incubator Evaluation and Recommendations

01

THE INCUBATOR'S PURPOSE

- 1 Support high-potential nonprofits that are ready to scale
- 2 Advance innovative approaches within UWGN's 9-county footprint
- 3 Increase UWGN's role as a strategic innovation partner (not just a funder)
- 4 Pilot a more flexible, growth-oriented support model

Brand Differentiation from Traditional UWGN Programming



Growth-driven



**Milestone-based
development conversations**



**Experimentation with
guardrails**



Leadership + scalability

Who We Talked To



Key Takeaways (Condensed)



- 1 Peer Cohort Model Drives the Most Value**
Cohort size should remain small but mighty (6-8 organizations)
- 2 Invest in Leadership, Not Just the Organization**
Selection process must include interviews and qualitative leadership evaluation
- 3 Capital Alone Is Insufficient**
Program should blend funding with structured advisory support
- 4 Start Small, Iterate, and Evaluate**
Design first cycle as a pilot with evaluation embedded
- 5 Flexibility Requires Structure**
"Flexible within a framework" should guide design

Proposed Offerings



Capital Support

- Milestone-based growth grants
- Match incentives
- Pilot innovation funding

Strategic Support

- Financial modeling
- Governance & board development
- Executive coaching

Network Access

- Corporate introductions
- UWGN event integration
- Peer-founder community

Brand Assets

- UWGN convening space
- Brand credibility
- Visibility amplification

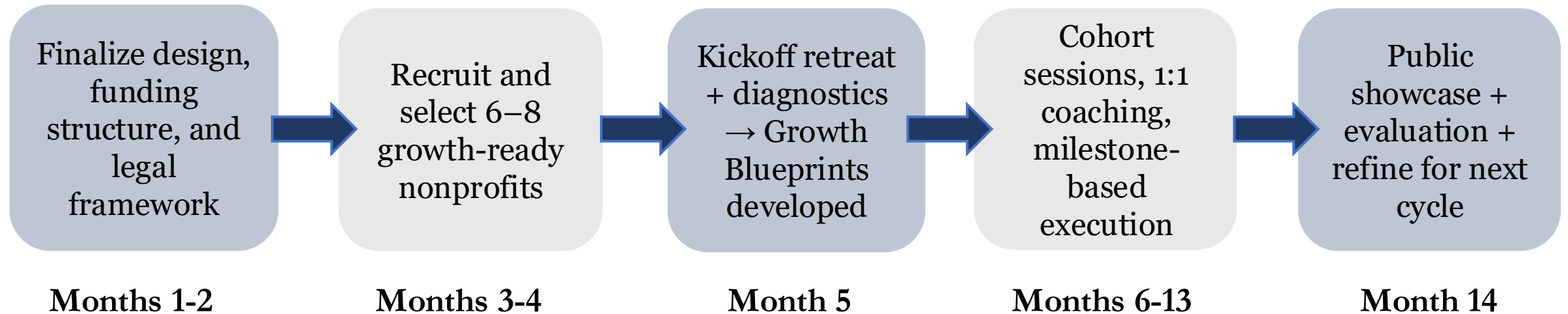
Interview Insights

- JumpStart: founder community created the most value
- GoodWork Seacoast: coaching and peer workshops drove impact
- Wean Foundation: shared space strengthened collaboration

Implication for UWGN Offering

- Prioritize peer cohort sessions and founder networking
- Provide structured executive coaching and cohort workshops
- Use UWGN facilities as a convening hub for participants

Overview of Roadmap



Key Program Selection Criteria

501(c)(3) status & strong organizational standing

Measurable community impact

Leadership readiness

Financial health

Scalability potential

Alignment with UWGN's priority areas

Potential Programs for UWGN Consideration



Example Participants

- 510 Foundation
- Creative Girls Rock
- Nashville Peacemakers
- Share Built
- Preservation Society of Nashville
- Be About Change
- Cul2vate

Geographic Considerations

- Assess nonprofit concentration in Davidson County vs surrounding counties
- Identify geographic service gaps across Middle Tennessee
- Prioritize organizations serving underserved communities
- Balance investment in established Nashville nonprofits with broader regional capacity-building

Student Ambassador Program Growth

02

Our 3 Workstreams



1

**Spreadsheet &
Outreach for
university contacts**

2

**Content for
university-specific
distribution**

3

**Strategic
recommendations on
program structure &
differentiators**

University Breakdown



We went for organizations that were active and community-oriented

Examples of Deliverable



Become a **United Way** Student Ambassador!

Lead the change on your campus. Build your legacy while serving your community.

**The Benefits**

**The Requirements**

01 Resume Building
Elite leadership & development skills.

02 Networking
Connect with regional non-profit leaders.

03 Social Features
Be featured on official social media channels.

04 Exclusive Gear
Your own 'Live United' ambassador t-shirt.

- Attend 4 volunteer events and bring 2 friends to each
- Participate in 1 United Way Day of Action
- Share event content on social media, tagging United Way
- Table at 2 school events to recruit peers

APPLY ONLINE TODAY
unitedwaynashville.org/students
PRIORITY DEADLINE: DAY/MO.

UWGN AMBASSADORS**FALL 2026 RECRUITMENT**

JOIN THE **IMPACT.**

Nashville's premier student leadership program is looking for the next generation of change makers.

**Lead Change**
Impact local Nashville communities through hands-on service and strategic advocacy.

**Build Skills**
Master project management, public speaking, and community organizing.

**Expand Network**
Connect with leaders, corporate partners, and a passionate student cohort.

READY TO MAKE YOUR MARK?

Scanning this code is the first toward a transformative experience that defines your college career.

**APPLICATIONS CLOSE MO./DAY**



Become a Campus Changermaker with



HOSTED BY: [Club]

 **Event:** [Event Name]

 **Date:** [Date]

 **Time:** [Time]

 **Location:** [Location]

**UNITED WAY**
Greater Nashville

2026

Student Ambassador Program

Bring Leadership and Community Impact to Your Campus: Partner with United Way's Student Ambassador Program

What is the United Way Student Ambassador Program?



Ambassador Requirements

Ambassadors take part in several experiences during the year, including leading volunteer events, participating in United Way's Day of Action, and supporting impact programs. These opportunities to engage with local nonprofits and strengthen leadership and teamwork skills.

Students also help share the impact of their work by creating digital content that highlights volunteer experiences and encourages others to

Attend 4+ volunteer events throughout the year. Bring a minimum of 2 friends to each

Spend 3+ hours volunteering for one or more United Way Community Impact programs

Share one piece of content from each event attended on social media and tag United Way

Table at 2 school events to promote United Way volunteer opportunities

UWGN AMBASSADORS**FALL 2026 RECRUITMENT**

JOIN THE **IMPACT.**

Nashville's premier student leadership program is looking



College students engage with **career-building opportunities**

Core Messaging Pillars:

1

Career-First Positioning

Emphasize:

- Resume value
- Skills
- Real-world experience

2

Leadership & Ownership

Frame as leadership opportunities, rather than general participation

3

Network Access

Promote connections with professionals, peers, and community leaders

Requirements Breakdown



Lead Impact Events

- Lead 4 United Way volunteer events

Participate in Signature Initiative

- Take part in 1 United Way Day of Action

Engage in Community Programs

- Contribute to United Way Community Impact Initiatives

Create & Share Content

- Develop digital content showcasing events and impact

Q&A